

SACRED REST

RECOVER YOUR LIFE, RENEW YOUR ENERGY, RESTORE YOUR SANITY

BY SAUNDRA DALTON-SMITH MD



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Dr. Saundra Dalton-Smith is a Board-Certified internal medicine physician and work-life integration researcher and the author of numerous books including bestseller "*Sacred Rest: Recover Your Life, Renew Your Energy, Restore Your Sanity.*"

She is the founder of Restorasis, a professional development agency dedicated to restoring wellbeing in the workplace through its proprietary framework to help companies support their employees with work-life integration and burnout prevention strategies.

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7 Type of Rest **THAT EVERY PERSON NEEDS**

PHYSICAL REST

MENTAL REST

SENSORY REST

CREATIVE REST

EMOTIONAL REST

SOCIAL REST

SPIRITUAL REST

WHY

**HAVE YOU EVER TRIED TO FIX AN ONGOING LACK OF ENERGY BY GETTING MORE SLEEP —
ONLY TO DO SO AND STILL FEEL EXHAUSTED?**

If that's you, here's the secret: You're suffering from a rest deficit because most of us are missing out on the other types of rest we desperately need.



Type 1

PHYSICAL REST

The first type of rest we need is physical rest, which can be passive or active. Passive physical rest includes sleeping and napping, while active physical rest means restorative activities such as yoga, stretching and massage therapy that help improve the body's circulation and flexibility.



Type 2

MENTAL REST

Schedule short breaks to occur every two hours throughout your workday; these breaks can remind you to slow down. You might also keep a notepad by the bed to jot down any nagging thoughts that would keep you awake.



Type 3

SENSORY REST

Closing your eyes for a minute in the middle of the day, as well as by intentionally unplugging from electronics at the end of every day. Intentional moments of sensory deprivation can begin to undo the damage inflicted by the over-stimulating world.



Type 4 CREATIVE REST

Creative rest reawakens the awe and wonder inside each of us. Do you recall the first time you saw the Grand Canyon, the ocean or a waterfall? Allowing yourself to take in the beauty of the outdoors — even if it's at a local park or in your backyard — provides you with creative rest.



Type 5

EMOTIONAL REST

Emotional rest which means having the time and space to freely express your feelings and cut back on people pleasing. Emotional rest also requires the courage to be authentic. An emotionally rested person can answer the question “How are you today?” with a truthful “I’m not okay” — and then go on to share some hard things that otherwise go unsaid.



Type 6 **SOCIAL REST**

If you're in need of emotional rest, you probably have a social rest deficit too. This occurs when we fail to differentiate between those relationships that revive us from those relationships that exhaust us. To experience more social rest, surround yourself with positive and supportive people.



Type 7

SPIRITUAL REST

The final type of rest is spiritual rest, which is the ability to connect beyond the physical and mental and feel a deep sense of belonging, love, acceptance and purpose. To receive this, engage in something greater than yourself and add prayer, meditation or community involvement to your daily routine.



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